



is that lots of electrons suddenly arrive at the wire, producing a pulse of electricity that can be measured on a meter and heard as a “click” (which translates to “trouble”).

In 1912, Hans Geiger along with John Mitchell Nuttall formulated the Geiger-Nuttall Rule, describing the linear relationship between the radioactive time constant and the logarithm of the range of alpha particles. To get more accurate readings, in 1911 Geiger invented a device to count radioactive alpha particles automatically in normal light. This was the original Geiger counter.

Unfortunately with the outbreak of war in Germany, Hans had to go serve as an artillery officer with the German army. Here he met Walther Muller, with whom he collaborated and improved on his previous version of the Geiger Counter, now called the Geiger-Muller Counter.

Today a geiger counter is used to detect radiation in food, test for danger in a nuclear reactor and detect radioactive rocks and minerals while prospecting. Imagine living in a room for a year and then finding out that an arm is growing out of your back. You can't? Thank Mr. Hans for that.

Gunpowder

This chemical is a product of our “have fire, will burn” mentality. Rumoured to have been discovered in the 6th century B.C. by Chinese alchemists who were on a quest to discover the elixir of life (which somehow led to the